

How We Did It

The methodology for the *BT-PRICE* Gen Z Consumption Behaviour Survey

THE GEN Z CONSUMPTION Behaviour Survey was co-designed by *Business Today* and People Research on India's Consumer Economy (PRICE) to generate statistically robust and policy relevant insights into the economic thinking, life-style preferences, and consumption patterns of young adults aged 18–29 years in urban India.

The study carried out by PRICE covers 12 major urban centres, comprising four metropolitan cities (Delhi, Mumbai, Kolkata, and Chennai) and eight Tier II cities (Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Jaipur, Lucknow, Pune, Indore, Kochi, and Surat). These cities represent India's most influential urban consumption markets, where Gen-Z participation in education, employment, entrepreneurship, and digital consumption is highly concentrated.

The final achieved sample consists of 4,311 individual respondents, exceeding the originally proposed sample size and thereby strengthening the statistical reliability of the findings. The expanded sample reduces the overall margin of error to approximately ±1.5–2% at a 95% confidence level, allowing for confident national-level inferences as well as robust subgroup comparisons across gender, age cohorts, city tiers, education levels, employment categories, and income classes.

It was conducted during a

two-week period from December 1–15, 2025 with a 34-point questionnaire.

Sampling was executed using a stratified random sampling framework. Respondents were stratified by city, gender, age group and household income, majority consisting of middle class and rich, to ensure proportional representation across metropolitan and Tier II urban contexts. Within cities, interviews were spread across mul-

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multiple urban wards and youth-dense locations to minimise clustering and selection bias. All respondents were interviewed as individuals rather than households, aligning with the study's focus on personal consumption behaviour and financial decision-making.

Data were collected using Computer-Assisted Personal Interviewing (CAPI) by trained field team of Research Investigators, Supervisors and Zonal Coordinators, supported by GPS tagging, real-time data monitoring, and multi-stage back-checks to ensure accuracy and data integrity. The final dataset provides a high-quality empirical foundation for analysing Gen-Z consumption behaviour across income strata,

occupational profiles, and socio-economic backgrounds in urban India.

RESPONDENTS' PROFILE

The final sample of 4,311 Gen-Z respondents reflects a balanced and diverse urban youth population.

- **City Type:** 51% of respondents are from metropolitan cities, while 49% are from Tier-II cities, enabling strong comparative analysis across urban tiers.

- **Gender:** The sample is well balanced, with 2,238 males (52%) and 2,073 females (48%).

- **Age Composition:** 12% are aged 18–21 years, 33% fall in the 22–25 years group, and 55%, are aged 26–29 years, reflecting Gen-Z's growing presence in the workforce.

- **Education:** The respondent base is highly educated: 79% are graduates or post-graduates, underscoring the urban, aspirational character of the cohort.

- **Employment Status:** 52% are privately salaried, 12% are government salaried, 33% are self-employed or entrepreneurs.

- **Income Profile:** Nearly 55% report annual personal incomes between ₹3 lakh and ₹10 lakh, while 18% earn above ₹10 lakh, highlighting significant purchasing power within the cohort.

- **Household Income Class:** Two-thirds (66%) belong to middle-income households, and 28% to high-income households, situating the sample firmly within India's urban consuming class. **BT**